  - Can you get reproducible builds for artifacts, such as container images of the agent?
  - Is the agent's supply chain known and/or documented?
- With security *of* the agent, try to determine the following:
  - Does the agent support TLS/HTTPS and equivalent cryptographically secured traffic?
  - Can you apply policies across a fleet of agents (e.g., credentials, access, and filters)?
  - Are mechanisms in place to deal with sensitive data, such as personally identifiable information (PII), as required by certain legislations, such as in Europe, through the General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR)?

Ideally, you will get this information up front, via a checklist from the open source project, ISV, or cloud provider vending the agent.

4.5.2 Agent performance and resource usage

Agent performance—that is, how fast signals can be processed, typically measured via the throughput along with the resources used—is a key evaluation criteria. The following are some examples of such performance-related reports:

- The upstream "OpenTelemetry Collector Performance" docs (http://mng.bz/QP96).
- The AWS Distro for OpenTelemetry Collector (ADOT) collector performance report (http://mng.bz/N2J1).

Zooming in on performance, one important criterion is, in a nutshell, related to the resource footprint of an agent. For example, a criterion might be how much RAM and/or CPU seconds the agent consumes in various phases (e.g., idle, on average, or peak) to collect, mutate, and ingest signals.

Along with this, you want to be able to have breakdowns across signal types in case of a multisignal agent, like the OpenTelemetry collector. Figure 4.11 shows an example screen capture of a Grafana dashboard (https://ref.otel.help/otel-collector-ops/otel-collector-dashboard.json) capturing OpenTelemetry collector resource usage over time.

In the context of resource usage, you want to make sure the resources the agent uses are few compared to your footprint. Don't forget the cumulative effect—that is, while a single agent might only use up a few MB across an entire fleet with several thousands of agents, that might sum up to the high TB range. Most agents nowadays have mechanisms that allow you to control resource usage (e.g., in the case of the OpenTelemetry collector, you can use the memory limiter processor to prevent out-of-memory (OOM) scenarios.